

Postpartum - Urination Pain - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1437 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- Postpartum painful urination assessment, combining NHS.UK's C-section recovery urinary-symptom warning with the cystitis guidance already used for Urination Pain - Female (batch14).
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [DURATION] How many days/weeks since delivery?
2. [TEMPERATURE] What is the temperature, if measured?
3. [YES_NO] Any back/flank pain or blood in the urine?
4. [YES_NO] If the patient is under 18, can they speak privately now, and do they say they feel safe with the accompanying adult?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Flank Pain

Is pain in the side or back below the ribs the primary concern rather than pain during urination?

Primary side or back pain below the ribs belongs in the Flank Pain pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Along with urinary symptoms, is there confusion, trouble breathing or very fast breathing, fainting, cold or clammy skin, or rapidly worsening severe illness?

These are sepsis red flags, and postpartum infection can progress quickly - always treated as an emergency.

1. Disposition level 70

Is there pain when urinating, leaking urine, back or flank pain, fever, or blood in the urine?

NHS.UK guidance lists painful or leaking urination after a C-section as needing prompt review, and the same applies to any postpartum delivery given the shared infection risk.

Advice

Emergency postpartum infection precautions

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 now. Do not let the patient drive. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: worsening confusion; worsening breathing.

Urgent postpartum urinary symptom review

- Arrange prompt clinical assessment; the exact non-emergency Qatar destination remains GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED. Postpartum urinary symptoms may need examination and testing.
- Call Back If: fever develops; back pain worsens.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 now. Do not let the patient drive. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Caesarean section - Recovery" (urinary symptom warning), <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/caesarean-section/recovery/> (page last reviewed 04 January 2023)
- NHS.UK, "Cystitis" (already cited for Urination Pain - Female, batch14), <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/cystitis/>

Provenance

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